

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

PROBLEM STATEMENT ID

SIH26090

PROBLEM STATEMENT

AI-Driven Market Linkage and Cataloging Mobile App for Marginalized Artisans

THEME

Miscellaneous

TEAM ID

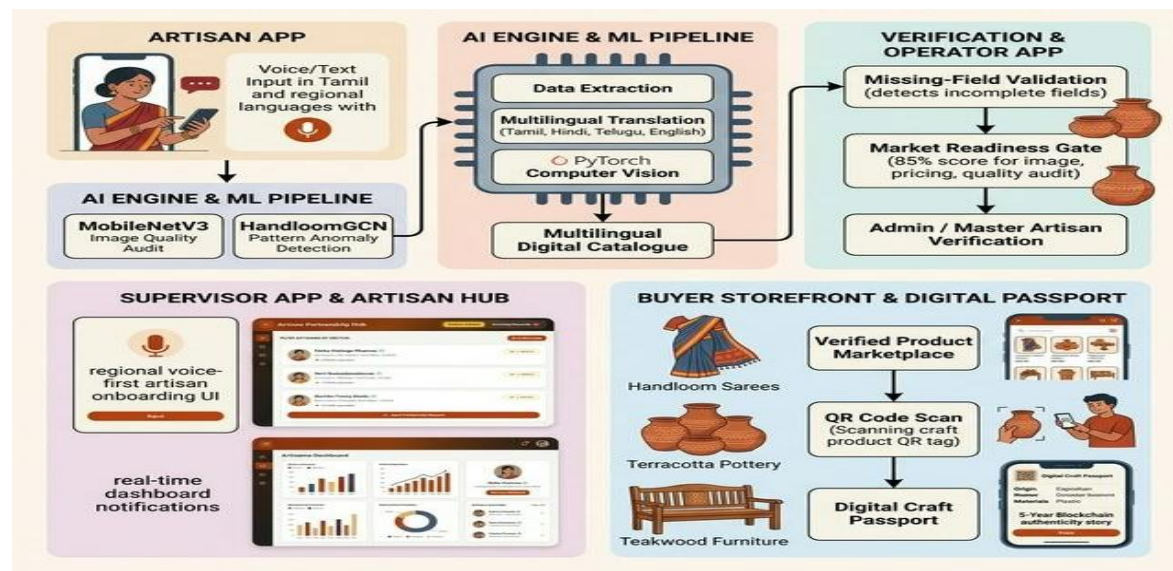
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TEAM NAME

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Kalora is an AI-powered, voice-first digital platform designed to help marginalized artisans create professional product catalogs, generate multilingual descriptions, receive fair price guidance, and connect with digital marketplaces. The solution addresses major barriers faced by artisans such as poor product presentation, language limitations, lack of digital cataloging skills, and limited access to broader buyers.

The platform allows artisans to capture product images, describe products through voice input in regional languages, and automatically generate market-ready listings with AI-assisted image enhancement, multilingual catalog content, and pricing support. Kalora also introduces trust-building and promotion tools such as QR-based product identity and social commerce content.



INTRODUCTION

India has a rich artisan and handicrafts ecosystem, but many artisans, weavers, and self-help group producers still struggle to access digital commerce effectively. Even when marketplace channels exist, many sellers face challenges in creating quality product images, writing buyer-friendly descriptions, selecting the right language, and presenting their products in a professional digital format.

Government-supported digital commerce ecosystems such as eSaras and ONDC are expanding market reach for artisan and SHG products, which makes digital readiness an important factor for successful participation. Kalora is designed as an enabling layer that helps artisans become digitally prepared, visible, and trusted in such commerce systems.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Marginalized artisans often produce culturally valuable handmade products but face multiple barriers in selling them digitally. These barriers include lack of high-quality product photos,

limited literacy in formal catalog writing, language mismatch between sellers and buyers, uncertainty in pricing, and difficulty in promoting products consistently online.

As a result, many artisans are unable to convert craftsmanship into strong digital market visibility, reducing their income opportunities and limiting access to larger national buyer networks.

Need for solution

- Artisan products need better digital presentation.
- Regional-language artisans need voice-first tools.
- Marketplace access alone is not enough without catalog readiness.
- Buyers need more trust and product clarity before purchase.
- Government digital systems increasingly require usability, multilingual capability, and accessible interfaces.

EXISTING SYSTEMS AND GAPS

Existing platforms such as eSaras provide online marketplace support for SHG and rural products and extend product visibility through ONDC-connected buyer applications. However, marketplace availability does not automatically solve the challenges of product digitization at the artisan level.

Gaps in current systems

- Many artisans still struggle to create quality catalogs.
- Product descriptions are often incomplete or inconsistent.
- Language and literacy barriers reduce self-service use.
- Pricing is usually not guided in a structured way.
- Digital trust and product verification are not always strongly visible to buyers.

KALORA'S ROLE

Kalora is positioned not as a replacement for such platforms, but as an AI-powered preparation and enablement layer that helps artisans create better listings and participate more effectively in digital commerce ecosystems.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

Kalora is a mobile-first platform that enables artisans to transform simple voice and image inputs into complete digital product listings. The artisan can photograph a product, describe it in their regional language, and receive an AI-generated output including enhanced product images, structured product fields, multilingual descriptions, and pricing suggestions.

The system is designed for low digital literacy environments. It uses voice-first interaction, large-button navigation, guided prompts, and simplified approval steps so that users can complete cataloging without needing technical expertise. This approach aligns with accessibility and multilingual usability expectations emphasized in Indian digital standards.

OBJECTIVES

- To help marginalized artisans create professional digital product catalogs.
- To enable voice-based product entry in regional languages.
- To generate multilingual catalog content for wider buyer reach.
- To improve product discoverability through better descriptions and structured metadata.
- To provide pricing guidance for fair and informed selling.
- To support digital trust through product identity and verification elements.
- To improve market linkage and online promotion for artisan-made products.

KEY FEATURES

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1. AI image enhancement

Improves raw product photos through background cleanup, lighting correction, cropping, and catalog-ready formatting.

2. Voice-based product entry

Allows artisans to describe products in their own language instead of typing long product details.

3. Smart product information extraction

Converts spoken input into structured fields such as product name, material, category, size, and usage.

4. Multilingual catalog generation

Generates product titles and descriptions in multiple languages to support broader market access.

5. Price guidance

Provides a recommended price range based on entered product information and declared production inputs.

6. Catalog completeness check

Detects missing product details and prompts the user to fill only the required fields.

7. Digital trust passport

Creates a QR-based product identity page that improves credibility and buyer trust.

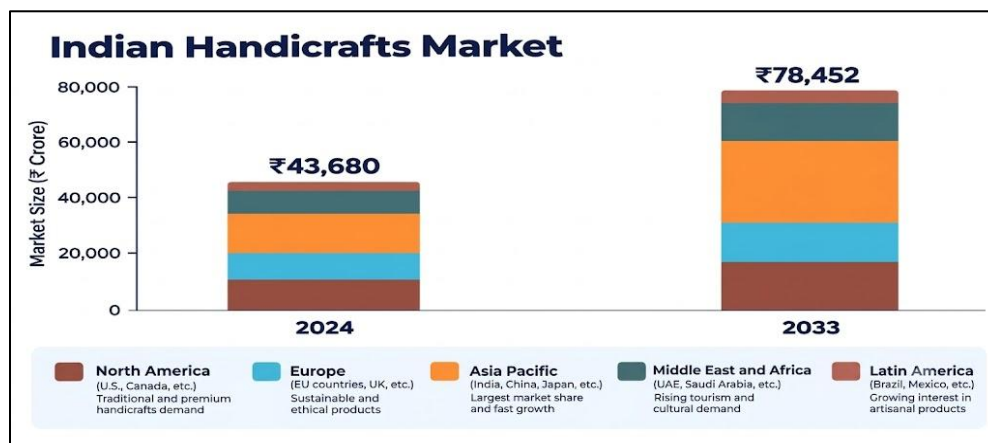
8. Social commerce assistant

Generates ready-to-use captions and promotional text for WhatsApp and social media.

MARKET ANALYSIS

Kalora operates in a growing handicrafts and digital-commerce opportunity space where artisans need better onboarding, catalog creation, discoverability, and direct buyer access. India's handicrafts market was valued at Rs. 40,500 crore in 2024 and is projected to reach Rs. 72,900 crore by 2033, while FY25 handicraft exports excluding hand-knotted carpets reached Rs. 33,122.79 crore, showing strong domestic and export potential.

Despite this opportunity, many artisans still struggle to participate effectively in e-commerce because of limited digital know-how, language barriers, weak branding, and high friction in online listing and promotion. Research and sector commentary note that voice-based, language-support, accessibility-first, and training-oriented digital tools can help close this gap, while ONDC's ecosystem is already onboarding new sellers, women entrepreneurs, and artisan clusters into digital commerce.



INNOVATION

Kalora is innovative because it does not function as just another marketplace; it acts as an AI-enabled commerce readiness assistant for artisans before and during online selling. Its key innovations include voice-first product entry, multilingual catalog generation, AI image enhancement, explainable fair-price suggestions, social-commerce content generation, and a digital craft passport that improves trust and authenticity.

A second layer of innovation is Kalora's culturally sensitive workflow, where AI-generated product stories and identity claims remain under artisan control instead of being published blindly. This is

especially relevant in the handicrafts sector, where provenance, authenticity, local identity, and direct market visibility strongly influence buyer trust and long-term value creation.

IMPACT

Kalora can create economic, social, and digital impact by helping artisans present products more professionally, reach wider markets, and reduce dependence on intermediaries. Digital platforms improve price realization, strengthen direct-to-customer access, and can support more stable incomes for artisan communities when combined with better branding and easier digital participation.

The app also has inclusion impact because it is designed around multilingual, accessibility-first, and low-friction workflows that match the real barriers many artisans face online. Research on artisan-focused platforms emphasizes that user-accessible, culturally aware digital tools can help preserve traditional crafts while improving business viability and market relevance.

CONCLUSION

Kalora is a practical and socially relevant solution because it addresses the real reasons artisans remain underrepresented in digital commerce: difficult onboarding, weak listing quality, language friction, and limited marketing capability. By combining AI assistance, multilingual access, trust-building features, and commerce-readiness support, Kalora can help artisans move from informal selling to scalable digital participation.

Its strength lies in linking tradition with technology in a way that is useful, respectful, and scalable. In a market where digital expansion, export growth, and open commerce infrastructure are all improving, Kalora has the potential to become an important bridge between artisan creativity and sustainable market access.